7. Reporting Spiking

You can report spiking to the police or to the university (or both), and this can be done anonymously or non-anonymously. You can report an incident at any time, no matter how long ago it happened.

It is always your choice whether to report a spiking incident. Some reasons people choose to report include:

- It may help resolve your case
- It can support your emotional recovery
- It may help prevent future incidents by identifying and stopping the perpetrator

7.1. Reporting to ARU [15, 16]

If you are a student or member of staff at ARU, you can report spiking to ARU anonymously using the Report and Support Tool here[16] (from 14 July 2025).

- You can report anonymously which does not require you to identify yourself and this means that university cannot take any formal or informal action, but the information will be used to help us prevent similar incidents happening again.
- You can also report non-anonymously using Report and Support Tool. You can also reach out to the student advice centre, if you are unsure about your reporting options and want additional support.
- Spiking is a difficult issue for universities to investigate because their powers are limited and victims are encouraged to report to the police, who have the authority to review CCTV, test samples, and investigate beyond the university's context. If you are worried about seeking support because of concerns about drug use or about getting into trouble, please know that ARU is here to help. Our priority is your safety and well-being. We encourage you to reach out for support without fear of judgment or repercussions. Whatever you choose to do, ARU will be able to support staff or students affected by spiking.
- Regardless of whether you choose to report spiking or not, you can access ARU's support[17] or other support for survivors of crime, such as Victim Support[18].

7.2. Reporting to police[7,8,19]

To report spiking to the police, you can call 101 (the non-emergency line) or report a crime online[19].

- If you report spiking to the police anonymously, they may still be able to investigate but won't be able to give you updates on the investigation.
- If you report spiking non-anonymously to the police, there are a few stages of the process. You can read about the initial stages here and the investigation process here.
- Having illegal drugs in your system (unless you are driving) is not a crime. Therefore, please do not hesitate to report incidents of spiking. Even if it occurred in a private home, reporting it will not necessarily get your hosts in trouble (unless they were responsible for the spiking). The person who spiked your drink is the one who committed the crime[7].

7.3. Your account of the incident

If you're comfortable talking about what happened, you may be asked to go over following main points:

- What happened?
- Where/ when do you think it happened?
- Do you know who might have done it?

You may have included these in your initial report, but this is a normal part of the process and doesn't mean you weren't believed the first time. It's alright if you're uncertain or don't remember exactly what happened. Drugs used for drink spiking can make you forget what happened during that time. It's like your memory of that time just disappears or can be fragmented. You will not be judged or blamed for what happened to you.

7.3.1. Collecting evidence

After reporting a spiking incident, you may be asked to provide a blood or urine sample for further investigation. You can read about forensic testing here. Currently, only the police can collect forensic evidence. In cases where spiking leads to sexual assault, Sexual Assault Referral Centres (SARCs) can also collect evidence[8].

Some drugs can leave the body within 12 hours, but others remain for longer. If you report spiking within 4 days of it happening, a police officer will visit you to provide a sterile urine collection container. They may have a doctor with them to take a blood sample. You don't have to give these samples if you don't want to.

If you report spiking more than 4 days after it happened, police will still investigate the case. In both cases, they may also visit the venue to look for other evidence including CCTV footage.

7.3.3. Spiking database - The Egalitarian[5]

The Egalitarian hosts a publicly viewable spiking database called Spike Report which reports how, when and where a spiking occurred as well as how the venue or emergency services responded. You can find Spike Report here - if you choose to share information, this will be published anonymously as part of their database. Please note that this information is not used for investigative purposes.